



GDD 48

Money & Independence

Standing on your own feet.

The College node for the Work & Money life-domain. It builds the financial literacy and autonomy that underpin an independent adult life: budgeting a stipend or first salary, saving and avoiding debt traps, the basics of earning and negotiating, money in relationships, and, crucially, financial independence as a foundation of equality and a route out of abuse, which matters most for the women this work exists for. Practical, not preachy. Educational, not financial advice. Seven mechanics, 28 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Money isn't just money.

Money & Independence builds the financial literacy and autonomy that underpin an independent adult life: budgeting a stipend or first salary, saving and avoiding debt traps, the basics of earning and negotiating, fair money in relationships, and, crucially, financial independence as a foundation of equality and a route out of abuse. It is practical, not preachy, and it is explicit that it is educational, not financial advice. New v2 build, anchoring the Work & Money domain in College, with a recurring equity thread on women's economic autonomy.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g48 · money-independence (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 6 · ages 18-22 · adult / practical / equity-forward
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills (Work & Money) · UNESCO 5.2, 2.2
Prerequisite / builds on	g47 (Own Your Health) · builds on g42 (Life Ready) · pairs g49, g52 · feeds g58
Gating	Open · educational, NOT financial advice (no products; no real financial data)
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the money-and-independence game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

15

myth-flips

28

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Money = freedom, especially for women. Financial independence buys choices, safety and the power to walk away, so this node treats money skills as life skills: a real budget, a saving habit, a clear-eyed view of debt traps, the confidence to earn and negotiate, and the knowledge to spot financial control. Because India has low women's workforce participation and a real pay gap, economic autonomy runs through it as an equity thread, and financial control in a relationship is named for what it is, a recognised form of abuse, not love.

A survival skill, for real life.

From the Chapter 6 personas (18-22). For first-generation and migrant young adults money is a survival skill, and for young women it is the foundation of autonomy. It must be practical and India-real, not a lecture.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Deepak, 20	To budget a tight stipend and not get into debt.	branch + sort : budget & traps.
Meena, 20	Money basics and scam-spotting, offline, with no safety net.	spot + sort : traps & fraud.
Aarti, 21	To value her own income and autonomy as her marriage is arranged.	strike-rewrite + role-play : money & love.
Every young woman	That economic independence is her safety and equality.	reflect + branch : money is freedom.

Why this works (the evidence). Practical skills build independence: a budget across needs, wants and savings (a rough 50/30/20 starting guide), paying yourself first, and an emergency fund of around three months of essentials, while high-interest debt, minimum-only payments and BNPL/EMIs on wants are real traps. Earning power and the pay gap matter: reading your payslip, knowing your worth and negotiating are normal and smart, and India's low women's workforce participation and pay gap make this an equity issue. And money is freedom: financial independence buys safety and the power to leave, while coerced debt, withholding money and controlling a partner's earnings are recognised economic abuse, covered in India under the Domestic Violence Act.

Seven moves, led by the choice.

It's a practical life-skills game, so **branch** leads (make the smart money move), with **strike-rewrite** clearing the money myths and **sort** drawing the lines (need vs want, trap vs sensible, control vs fair). Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE YOUNG ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (the choice) signature	Makes the smart, independent money move in a real situation.	Autonomy.	20
sort	Sorts need vs want; trap vs sensible; control vs fair money.	The line.	16
strike-rewrite	Busts a money myth ("BNPL is free money"; "men handle the money").	Conceptual change.	15
reflect	Internalises money as freedom, safety and equality.	Values.	12
match	Pairs a budget slice to a category; an issue to a help route.	Connections.	8
role-play (voice)	Negotiates pay; sets fair money terms; encourages independence.	Voice; advocacy.	8
spot	Spots the scam, the debt spiral, the financial control.	Reading the signs.	5

28 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is the quiet satisfaction of competence and control: a light money-sim where balancing a real stipend across needs, wants and savings actually clicks, and the relief of seeing a scam or a debt trap coming. The "so that's where my money went" and "I don't have to just accept this pay" moments are genuinely empowering. Sam is a frank, practical adult peer; the tone is real and never preachy or moralising, and it never promotes a product or asks for real financial data.

Is it teaching?

Yes: budgeting income and expenses; building a savings habit and recognising debt traps; the basics of payslips, the pay gap and negotiating; managing money fairly in a relationship and spotting financial control as a form of abuse; and valuing financial independence as safety and equality, especially for women, all within an explicit educational-not-advice frame.

The belief it moves. From "budgeting is deprivation; I'll save when I earn more; BNPL is free money; men handle the money; depending on a partner is fine if you trust them" → "a budget is control; the saving habit matters now; BNPL is debt; everyone needs financial independence; and your own income is your safety net."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the budget → save-and-traps → earn-and-ask → money-and-love → money-is-freedom → tools arc, India-grounded and educational (not advice). Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Budget it	14	sort, branch, reflect	Needs/wants/savings, tracking, a starting 50/30/20 guide.
Save & avoid traps	16	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Emergency fund, debt, EMIs, BNPL, scams.
Earn & ask	15	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Payslips, the pay gap, negotiating fairly.
Money & love	16	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Fair money; financial control as abuse.
Money is freedom	12	reflect, branch, sort	Independence as safety & equality, esp. for women.
Tools & help	11	match, sort, reflect	Budget tools, reliable sources, help routes.

The 'BNPL is free money' flip + a financial-control flip, verbatim.

flip: "Buy now, pay later is basically free money."
 UN -> "Buy now, pay later is free money."
 RE -> "BNPL and easy EMIs are debt; they often lead to overspending and missed payments."

flip: "A partner controlling all the money is just being practical."
 UN -> "A partner controlling all the money is just practical."
 RE -> "Controlling, withholding or blocking your access to money is financial control, a form of

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 48 Money and Independence — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Budgeting just means depriving yourself.	A budget gives you control and choices, not deprivation.	Budget mindset.
I'll start saving once I earn more.	Build the saving habit now, even small; the habit beats the amount.	Start now.
Buy now, pay later is free money.	BNPL and easy EMIs are debt that often leads to overspending.	Debt traps.
Negotiating your pay is greedy.	Knowing your worth and asking is normal, professional and smart.	Negotiation.
Men handle the money; women needn't worry.	Everyone, especially women, needs financial knowledge and independence.	Equity.
A partner controlling all the money is just practical.	Controlling or withholding money is financial control, a form of abuse.	Financial control.
Depending on a partner is fine if you trust them.	Financial independence is your safety net, regardless of trust.	Independence.
A get-rich-quick offer is a real opportunity.	Too good to be true means a scam; real wealth builds slowly.	Scams.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (practical adult peer) surfaces a real money moment, a stipend, a loan, a payslip, a partner.
2. **Choose.** The young adult makes the smart, independent move (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a money myth; RE writes the practical, empowering truth.
4. **Budget & build.** A light sim to balance income; build a saving habit; dodge debt traps and scams.
5. **Tools & help.** A budget tool and checklists; financial control routes to DV help (181/1091).
6. **Sticker.** The Independence badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **budget sim** and the **money-as-freedom** reframe. It anchors the Work & Money domain, builds on Life Ready (g42), pairs with Mind & Belonging (g49) and Find Your Feet (g52), and continues into Money, Together (g58) when shared finances begin.

Educational, equity-forward, safe.

- **Educational, not financial advice.** Clearly stated; it builds skills and judgment, promotes no products, and points to qualified help for big decisions.
- **Financial control named as abuse.** Coerced debt, withholding and controlling earnings are named as economic abuse and routed to DV help where relevant.
- **Equity-forward.** Women's economic autonomy runs throughout as a foundation of equality and safety.
- **Practical, not preachy.** Real budgeting, saving and earning for a real stipend or salary; no moralising.
- **No real data.** The sim uses example figures; no real financial data is collected (DPDP-aligned, on-device).
- **Scam-aware.** Common frauds (OTP/UPI, fake jobs, get-rich schemes) are flagged with the right reporting routes.
- **Access & tech.** Self-directed, audio, offline, low-end build; private by design.

Help & routes (India). Financial control or abuse, Women Helpline 181 / women-in-distress 1091 · scams and fraud, [cybercrime.gov.in / 1930](https://cybercrime.gov.in/) · money basics, a bank or a qualified, trusted source. Financial control is a recognised form of abuse under the Domestic Violence Act, and it isn't your fault. This is education, not personal financial advice, so check big decisions with a qualified person.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. money-independence** — `node.game === GameDone` key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **branch** money choice leads, with a light budget sim.
- **Educational-not-advice is a hard requirement.** The not-financial-advice frame, no-product-promotion and no-real-data rules are contractual; financial-control content is flagged for DV-aware review.
- **Fact-checked content.** 50/30/20 as a guide, emergency-fund norms, BNPL/EMI traps, the India pay gap and women's participation, and financial control under the DV Act verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 24%, 0% binary, 28 autonomy, 15 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Financial control and fraud route via the shared "get help" component (181 / 1091 / 1930).
- **Tracked.** `build_gate.py` finalize advances g48 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): educational, NOT financial advice; no products promoted; no real financial data; financial control named as abuse; equity-forward (women's autonomy); scam-aware; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Skills, not lectures, build independence.** Because a budget, a saving habit and an emergency fund are concrete and learnable, teaching them practically, with a sim, turns financial knowledge into real autonomy.
- **Earning power is an equity issue.** Since India's pay gap and low women's workforce participation are structural, knowing your payslip, your worth and how to negotiate is both a personal and an equity skill.
- **Independence is safety.** Because financial control is a recognised form of abuse and survivors often stay because of it, framing economic independence as freedom and safety, and naming financial control, is genuinely protective.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Work & Money learning (5.2, 2.2); personal-finance basics (50/30/20 as a starting guide, emergency funds, debt and BNPL/EMI traps); UN Women on women's economic empowerment and financial independence; India gender pay-gap and women's workforce-participation data; economic-abuse research and India's Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act 2005 (financial control). Educational, not financial advice; no products promoted; no real financial data collected; equity-forward and made-for-India. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 48 games now v2. Next by order: Mind & Belonging (g49).